

Jamie Cheng

A People-focused, Relationship-driven, and Evidence-based Professional
Dedicated to Supporting Student Growth and Success

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June 14, 2026

Dear Oregon State University Hiring Team,

What drew me to this Academic Advising Specialist role is a belief that has run through all of my work: people make better decisions when someone takes the time to understand their goals, meets them where they are, and connects them to the right resources. My academic foundation is in exactly this space—I hold a BA in Psychology and Education Studies from Wesleyan, where I completed a Practicum in Education Studies and coursework in Educational Psychology, Learning and Motivation, and student development. I went on to earn a master's in Applied Organizational Psychology, which deepened how I think about helping people grow. Supporting a diverse population of students toward degree completion and meaningful next steps is work I would find genuinely energizing.

In my current role at InGenius Prep, much of my day is spent supporting students and program participants. I facilitate live workshops and webinars for 600+ participants, develop guides and sample plans that help people navigate complex processes, and run needs assessments with stakeholders to understand where learners are getting stuck so I can design programs that actually help. I keep careful records and resources across 20+ programs, and I'm comfortable using systems and data to track progress and prepare reports—skills I know are central to monitoring an advising caseload. Earlier, at NextGen Healthcare, I analyzed 2,000+ individual survey responses and translated them into recommendations leaders acted on, and across roles I've built rapport with people from many backgrounds and cultures, which is at the heart of proactive, equity-minded advising.

I want to be candid about fit. My experience supporting and guiding people has come through educational programs, training, and consulting rather than a formal higher-education advising office, so academic-advising systems like DegreeWorks or Banner would be new tools for me to learn. What I bring instead is a strong, relevant foundation—an education-and-psychology academic background, real experience advising and supporting learners through workshops and one-on-one connection, a commitment to educational equity in multicultural settings, and a track record of picking up new systems quickly. I'm a fast, careful learner who genuinely enjoys the relationship-building this role centers on. I'd welcome the chance to bring that to the College of Forestry's advising team. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Jamie Cheng

Jamie (Yi-Chieh) Cheng